DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 7

UX designer

Profession 7 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A UX designer shapes how a product works for its users: research, journeys, flows, usability and testing. UX is about the whole experience, not the look alone.

What professionals do every day

Interviews users, maps journeys, writes problem statements, designs flows and prototypes, tests with users, measures results and works with product and engineering teams.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Products fail when users cannot finish their task. UX designers find where people get stuck and fix it before engineers build the wrong thing.

- Users who drop off in the middle of a task.
- Features nobody understands.
- Expensive rebuilds caused by late discovery.

Skills you need

- User research: interviews and surveys.
- Journey mapping and problem statements.
- Information architecture and flows.
- Usability testing and metrics.
- Accessibility basics.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Figma	Prototypes and flows	Free starter	Paid plans	www.figma.com
Maze	Remote usability tests	Free tier	Paid plans	maze.co
Miro	Journey maps and workshops	Free tier	Paid plans	miro.com
Nielsen Norman Group	Research articles	Free articles	Paid courses	www.nngroup.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Interview five users and summarise pain points.
Intermediate	Map one journey and find three drop-off points.

Advanced	Test a prototype with five users and fix the top problem.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Booking flow redesign.
- **Intermediate:** Onboarding for a learning app.
- **Advanced:** Checkout usability study.

Client-ready portfolio project

A UX case study for a fictional clinic's booking flow: research summary, journey map, a redesigned flow, a prototype and a five-person test with results.

Worked example

Worked example. Five of five users stopped at the date picker. The fix is a clearer date control with the next available slots shown first; the retest finished the task with no help.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Usability test and fix

Business problem: A clinic's booking flow loses users at the date step.

Steps

1. Recruit five users matching the patient profile.
2. Give each a task: book a visit for next week.
3. Record where each user stops or hesitates.
4. Redesign the top issue and retest with five new users.

Expected output: A test summary with before and after completion counts.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Completion rises only when the fix addresses the observed problem. Keep the test script identical so the comparison is fair. Report counts, not impressions.

Common mistakes

- Testing with colleagues instead of real users.
- Asking leading questions.
- Making changes without the evidence from testing.
- Ignoring accessibility.

Freelancing opportunities

- UX research and redesign projects.

- Prototype and usability testing services.
- Briefs for 'UX design', 'usability testing', 'prototype'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Nielsen Norman Group articles
- Interaction Design Foundation (check current free and paid content)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.